

Before you begin

This is a gentle starting-point check for maths and English. Use short sessions on different days. You do not need to finish every page.

How to use it

- Tell him: “This helps us choose what to practise. It is fine to say you don’t know.”
- Start with Maths A and English A. Try one or two sections per session, about 10–15 minutes. There is no time limit.
- Pause a section after two consecutive questions he cannot attempt, or sooner if he becomes upset. A difficult skill need not prevent trying a different skill later.
- For maths, read or translate instructions. Let him point, draw, or explain in his strongest language. Use counters if helpful; record that support. Avoid a calculator for this check.
- For English reading, let him try first. Then you may read the passage aloud and ask the questions again. Record reading and listening separately.
- Do not teach the answer during an independent attempt. If you help afterwards, record what changed.

Record each question

I = correct independently **S** = correct with support

P = needs practice **—** = not tried

Record translation separately from maths help: understanding a translated question still gives useful evidence about his maths.

Background

Name: _____ Date: _____

UK nation / school curriculum: _____

Strongest language: _____

How long has he been learning through English? _____

Scope: England is the provisional reference. Other UK nations have different curricula. These are selected skill samples, not a standardised test or a complete year assessment.

Numbers • getting started

Name: _____ Date: _____

You can draw, use objects, or leave a question for later.

A

1. Count the dots: • • • • • • •

2. Write the missing number: 12, 13, ____, 15

3. Circle the larger number: 17 9

4. $6 + 3 =$

5. $10 - 4 =$

6. Share 8 objects equally between 2 people. How many each?

B

1. In 47, how many tens and how many ones?

2. $27 + 15 =$

3. $52 - 26 =$

4. $5 \times 4 =$

5. $18 \div 2 =$

6. Find $\frac{1}{4}$ of 12.

Numbers • next steps

C

1. In 362, what is the value of the digit 6?

2. $146 + 238 =$

3. $403 - 178 =$

4. $7 \times 8 =$

5. $84 \div 4 =$

6. Find $\frac{1}{3}$ of 24.

D

1. Round 3,746 to the nearest 100.

2. $2,406 + 1,785 =$

3. $3,002 - 1,647 =$

4. $23 \times 6 =$

5. $96 \div 4 =$

6. $\frac{3}{7} + \frac{2}{7} =$

Numbers • a further challenge

E

1. $4.7 + 2.85 =$

2. $6 - 2.38 =$

3. $34 \times 12 =$

4. $156 \div 6 =$

5. $\frac{1}{2} + \frac{1}{4} =$

6. A rectangle is 8 cm long and 5 cm wide. What is its area?

F

1. Find 25% of 240.

2. $\frac{3}{4} - \frac{1}{6} =$

3. $\frac{2}{3} \times \frac{3}{5} =$

4. $3.6 \div 4 =$

5. Solve: $x + 17 = 42$.

6. The ratio of red counters to blue counters is 2 : 3. There are 20 counters altogether. How many are red?

Words • getting started

Take your time. You can say “pass”.

A • Words and sentences

Read these words aloud:

cat shop rain night

play little because jumped

Read these sentences aloud:

Sam has a red bag.

He puts a book in the bag.

Then he walks to school.

1. What colour is Sam's bag?

2. What does Sam put in the bag?

3. Where does Sam go?

Your writing

Write one sentence about something you like.

Write one sentence about something you did yesterday.

Reading • a short story

B • The seed

Read aloud if you feel comfortable.

On Monday, Aisha planted a seed in a pot. She put it beside the kitchen window and watered it a little each morning. By Friday, a tiny green shoot had appeared. Her brother wanted to move the pot into a dark cupboard to keep it safe. Aisha shook her head. “Let’s leave it here,” she said.

1. What did Aisha plant?

2. Where did she put the pot?

3. What had appeared by Friday?

4. Why might Aisha want the pot to stay by the window?

Your writing

Write 3–5 sentences about how to look after a plant or a pet. You can use: **first, next, because.**

Reading • thinking more deeply

C • The race

At the start of the race, Leo stood a little apart from the others. He checked his shoelaces twice and kept his eyes on the ground. When the whistle blew, he ran steadily, saving his energy for the final lap. Ahead of him, a runner stumbled. Leo slowed to ask whether she was all right. By the time he started running again, the leaders were far away. He crossed the line fourth. His coach smiled and held out a hand. Leo's shoulders relaxed.

1. Name two things Leo did before the race began.

2. How might Leo have felt before the start? Give a clue from the story.

3. Why did Leo slow down?

4. What might the coach have admired about Leo? Explain using the story.

Your writing

Which matters more in a race: winning or helping someone? Write a short paragraph with a reason and an example. You may take a different view from Leo.

English • adult observation guide

First, a short conversation

Use a real pencil, book and cup. Ask the following in English without gestures first. Repeat once if needed; record this. Later try gestures or his strongest language and record any difference.

1. "Point to the book."
2. "Put the pencil beside the cup."
3. "Pick up the pencil, then put it on the book."
4. "Tell me about something you enjoy."
5. "Tell me what you did yesterday."

Record understanding and speaking separately. Accept pointing for the first three tasks. For speaking, note whether he communicates using single words, phrases or connected sentences. Do not mark accent or dialect as wrong.

Reading answers

A: red; a book; school. Record each word separately, including sounding out and self-correction. This tiny word sample cannot establish a phonics level.

B: a seed; beside the kitchen window; a tiny green shoot; a plausible inference that the plant needs light and the window provides it.

C: any two: stood apart, checked his shoelaces twice, looked at the ground; nervous/unsure with a relevant clue (other supported interpretations are valid); to check on the runner who stumbled; kindness, care or sportsmanship, linked to stopping to help.

Accept short oral answers or pointing to relevant text. If you read the passage aloud, label the later answers **listening comprehension**. If translated, label the language used; these are not independent English reading results.

Writing: observe, do not assign a total

For each sample, record: clear meaning; complete sentences; capitals and full stops; spelling he can manage independently; linked ideas; and reasons or details. Record copied, dictated or translated help. Discuss ideas orally afterwards to see what he wanted to communicate.

Approximate curriculum links

A samples early word/sentence skills and some Year 1–2 content. B samples comprehension and connected writing relevant to Years 2–4. C samples evidence-based inference and reasoned writing relevant to Years 3–6. English skills overlap: these brief passages cannot distinguish individual year levels.

Maths • answers and next steps

Section / rough reference	Answers, in question order
A · foundations / Year 1	7; 14; 17; 9; 6; 4 each
B · Year 2 samples	4 tens and 7 ones; 42; 26; 20; 9; 3
C · Year 3 samples	60; 384; 225; 56; 21; 8
D · Year 4 samples	3,700; 4,191; 1,355; 138; 24; 5/7
E · Year 5 samples and earlier skills	7.55; 3.62; 408; 26; $\frac{3}{4}$; 40 cm ²
F · Year 6 samples and earlier skills	60; 7/12; 2/5; 0.9; 25; 8 red

Use the results to choose practice

- If he answers a section comfortably and independently, offer the next section.
- If answers are mixed, identify the particular skill: place value, subtraction, division, fractions, etc. Practise that skill with easier examples.
- If most questions need maths help, return to simpler examples and objects for those skills.
- If translating instructions helps, record that separately. Do not interpret difficulty with English wording as proof of weak maths.
- Use a few fresh examples on another day to see whether the skill is secure. Do not label him “Year 2” based on this sheet.

This check emphasises number. It does not cover the full maths curriculum, including all geometry, measures, time, money, statistics or problem-solving.

Bring this summary to his teacher

He can do independently: _____

He can do with language support: _____

Skills to practise next: _____

Ask his teacher to review maths, reading, English understanding and speaking separately. Tell them his strongest language and how long he has learned in English. If English is an additional language, ask about EAL support.

Reference: England's Department for Education programmes of study. Original practice questions; not an official or standardised assessment.

[Mathematics curriculum](#) · [English curriculum](#)